

A TRAGEDY BENEATH THE WAVES

Hackathon 4

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PROBLEM DEFINITION

What?

Marine plastic pollution

Every day single-use waste entering marine habits, breaking into microplastics putting marine life at risk

How big?

- 11 million metric tons of plastic enter oceans annually
- 85% of marine litter is plastic
- 700+ marine species threatened
- 100,000+ marine mammals killed annually
- 3x projected volume growth by 2040 (without intervention)

When & where?

Escalating **daily** across **global shorelines and open oceans**



TARGET AUDIENCE

Who?

Primary school children (age 6-10)

- Highly empathetic
- Visually driven



What they already believe



*The ocean is huge
one piece won't hurt*

*Plastic in the trash
disappears forever*

*Fish and turtles know
that plastic isn't food*

Who is it not for?

- High school students
- University environmental science students
- Policymakers
- Corporate executives.

WHY? It avoids complex chemical breakdowns, technical policy jargon, or disturbing graphic footage.

Why this target audience?

1. Habit formation

- Core waste and consumption habits are fixed by age 9
- Establishing baseline eco-friendly habits early avoids the difficulty of unlearning wasteful adult routines.

2. Peak environmental receptivity

- Empathy Peak: Natural affinity for animals reaches its maximum between ages 6–10 before dipping in early adolescence.
- Primary school kids are in the most emotionally open stage to connect with narrative animal welfare stories.

3. Child-to-parent influence

- 80%–85% of parents report kids influence household single-use and packaging choices.
- Children can act as household change agents, bypassing adult political or ideological resistance.

Why our solution is appropriate:

Personalized loss:

Framing marine life as a "family unit" transforms abstract pollution into a relatable personal tragedy.

Moral equality:

Children aged 6–10 view animals as emotional equals with human-like family structures.

Visual impact:

Seeing direct harm to character families drives higher action than statistical warnings.



How does it address SDG 13?

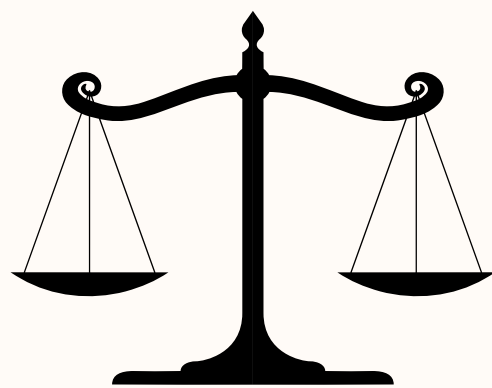
Connecting land waste to ocean climate

- The film demonstrates how human consumption on land (single-use trash, abandoned fishing gear) directly destroys marine ecosystems.
- By showing that marine waste kills fish and degrades reefs, the film teaches children that healthy ocean life is essential for maintaining a stable climate.

Translating complex ecological harm into concrete narrative

- Showing a tragic family loss gives kids a clear cause-and-effect relationship ("Our waste destroys ocean families"), fulfilling Target 13.3's goal of building early awareness.

ETHICAL REFLECTION



- **Informing vs. Misleading:**

The film informs by accurately demonstrating how human litter reaches global oceans and affects marine species. It avoids misleading by keeping creature behaviors realistic rather than creating sensationalized, fictional sea monsters.

- **Real Places & Events:**

The setting represents a generalized, global coral reef and open ocean rather than pretending to document a specific, real-world historical event or precise coordinate.